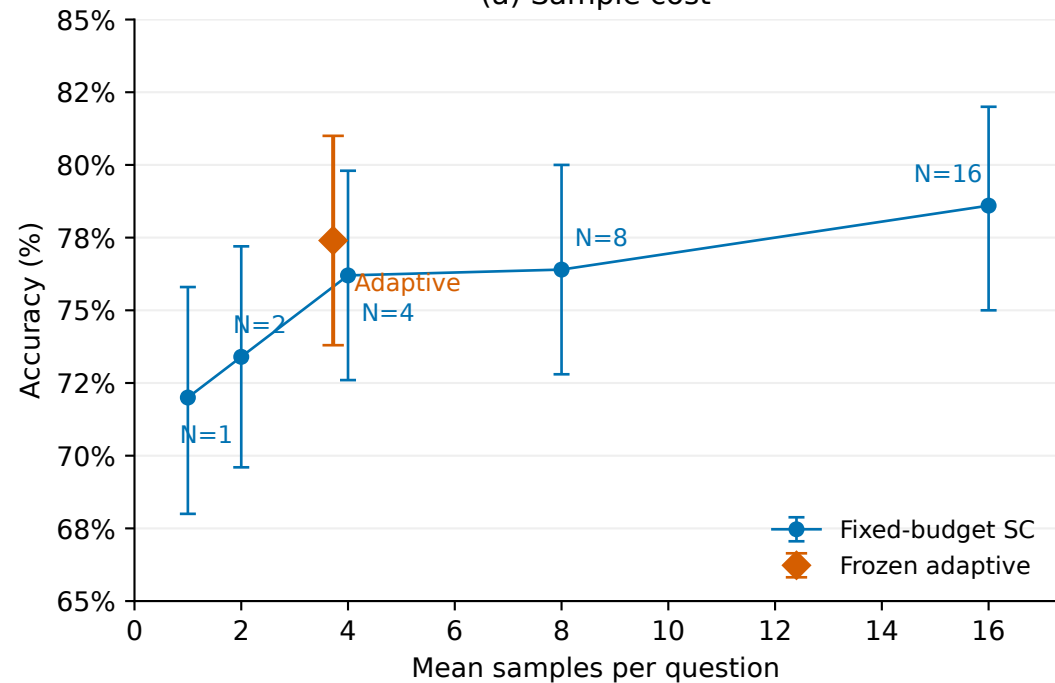
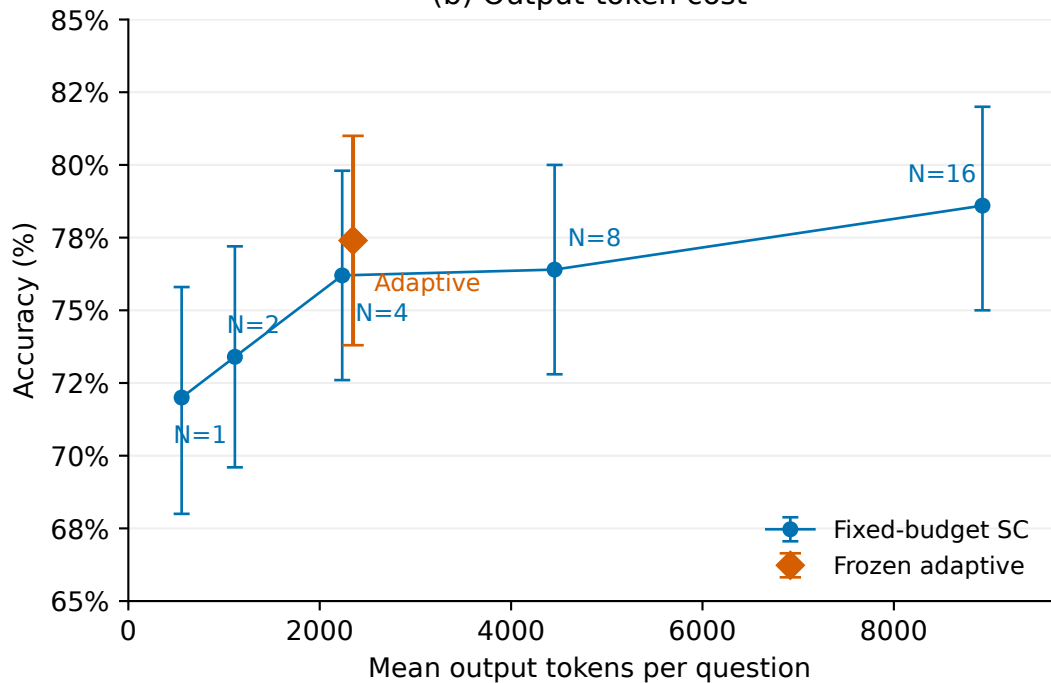


Prospective adaptive versus fixed-budget self-consistency

(a) Sample cost



(b) Output-token cost



Adaptive cost is counterfactual prefix cost; full experiment generated 8,000 samples.